Project Report

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy | VIT Bhopal University

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Branch / Year	B.Tech – Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning | First Year
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GitHub Repo	github.com/Sarvagya-102007/Digital-Literacy-Portfolio

This report documents all five tasks completed as part of the Digital Literacy Portfolio project for the CSE0001 course. It covers infographic creation, professional profiling, platform exploration, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness.

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Each task maps to a module of the course and required hands-on engagement with real platforms and tools — from creating an infographic on Canva to writing professional emails, setting up profiles on GitHub and LinkedIn, completing a coding challenge on HackerRank, and producing a cybercrime awareness case study. All work is organised in a public GitHub repository and documented in this report.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic | Module 1 | 20 Marks

Overview

For Task 1, I created a one-page visual infographic titled **"Digital Literacy Awareness"** using **Canva**, a free browser-based design platform. The infographic was designed to be clear, visually engaging, and immediately useful for first-year students encountering these concepts for the first time.

Topics Covered in the Infographic

What is Digital Literacy?	Ability to use digital devices, apps, and the internet effectively, responsibly, and safely — including evaluating information and understanding digital risks.
Useful Digital Tools	Google Docs (documents), Canva (design), GitHub (code collaboration), Zoom/Meet (communication).
Safe Internet Practices	Strong unique passwords, avoiding suspicious links, never sharing personal/financial information, staying alert to phishing.
Professional Online Presence	Clean social media, strong LinkedIn profile, sharing academic/professional achievements for career opportunities.

Reflection

I chose Canva because it offers a large library of professional templates and requires no design experience. Arranging four topics into a single slide without overcrowding was the most challenging aspect — I found that using coloured panels with consistent fonts helped separate each section clearly. I was particularly interested in the

"Professional Online Presence" section, as I had not previously considered how my social media activity could affect future career prospects. The task reinforced that digital literacy is not just a technical skill but also a professional and ethical responsibility.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio | Module 2 | 20 Marks

Platforms Set Up

GitHub	Version control and code hosting platform. Created profile (Sarvagya-102007) with four public repositories including JARVIS, Digital-Literacy-Portfolio, Pneumonia_Detection, and AI-HEALTH-ASSISTANT.
LinkedIn	Professional networking platform. Profile created under Sarvagya Gupta, with education section filled for B.Tech AIML at VIT Bhopal University.
ResearchGate	Academic research networking platform. Profile created for Sarvagya Gupta at VIT Bhopal University, with research metrics tracking set up for future publications.

GitHub Repositories Highlight

- ✓ **JARVIS** – Python desktop voice assistant using pyttsx3 and speech_recognition.
- ✓ **Digital-Literacy-Portfolio** – This portfolio repository for CSE0001.
- ✓ **Pneumonia_Detection** – Deep learning web app using VGG16 to detect pneumonia from X-rays.
- ✓ **AI-HEALTH-ASSISTANT** – Smart health monitoring system suggesting possible conditions.

Reflection

I chose GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate because together they cover three distinct professional audiences — technical collaborators, industry recruiters, and academic researchers. GitHub will be central to all my coding projects over the next four years. LinkedIn will help me connect with internship opportunities and professionals in the AI/ML field. ResearchGate is a long-term investment: although I have no publications yet, setting up the profile early means I will already have a presence when I begin contributing to research in later years. The most valuable insight from this task was realising that a professional digital identity is built incrementally — and starting in the first year gives a significant advantage.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms | Module 3 | 20 Marks

Part A – Coding Practice (HackerRank)

I created an account on **HackerRank** and completed a beginner-level coding challenge. Both test cases (Test Case 0 and Test Case 1) passed with a compiler status of **"Success"**. The expected outputs — 5, 1, and 6 — were matched exactly by my solution, confirming correctness. The challenge helped me practise structured input/output handling in a timed, evaluated environment.

Part B – Google Workspace (Digital Literacy Quiz Form)

I created a five-question **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** using Google Forms, covering password safety, phishing, secure internet practices, and the definition of digital literacy. The form was shared with batchmates and received three responses on 28th March 2026. Scores ranged from 20/100 to 80/100, revealing that concepts like phishing and secure password creation were understood by most respondents, while the definition of digital literacy itself was less clear to some.

Reflection

Using HackerRank gave me a structured, feedback-driven environment that I found far more motivating than practising on paper. The instant compiler feedback — pass or fail — makes it easy to iterate. Google Forms surprised me with how quickly a professional-looking quiz can be created and distributed. Analysing the three responses made the data immediately meaningful: it confirmed that some digital literacy concepts are still poorly understood even among tech students, validating the need for exactly this kind of awareness project. Both tools will continue to be part of my academic workflow.

Task 4 – Professional Email Etiquette | Module 4 | 20 Marks

Part A – Email Summaries

Email 1 – Deadline Extension	Written to a professor requesting an assignment extension until 4th April 2026. Subject line: 'Request for Assignment Deadline Extension'. Professional tone, clear reason given (unforeseen circumstances), specific new date requested, proper sign-off with name and registration number.

Email 2 – Internship Application	Written to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer opportunity. Subject line: 'Application for Summer Internship Opportunity'. Introduced current degree (B.Tech AIML), expressed willingness to contribute, referenced attached details, polite and concise close.

Part B – Social Media Do's and Don'ts

Do's

- ✓ Think before you post or share any content.
- ✓ Maintain a respectful and positive tone online.
- ✓ Protect your privacy by limiting personal information shared.
- ✓ Verify information before sharing to avoid spreading misinformation.
- ✓ Use social media for learning, networking, and personal growth.

Don'ts

- ✗ Don't post offensive, abusive, or inappropriate content.
- ✗ Don't share fake news or unverified information.
- ✗ Don't engage in cyberbullying or online arguments.
- ✗ Don't overshare personal details such as phone number, address, or passwords.
- ✗ Don't let social media negatively affect your studies or mental health.

Communication Scenario Reflection

A notable real-world scenario involving poor digital communication is the case of employees losing jobs after posting dismissive or discriminatory remarks on personal social media accounts, assuming their employer would not see them. In many such cases, screenshots were shared widely, the content went viral, and the employer terminated employment within days. What could have been done differently: the person could have applied the simple test — 'Would I say this in a professional setting?' — before posting. This task reinforced that there is no true private space online, and that digital communication leaves a permanent record.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness | Module 5 | 20 Marks

Part A – Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

I chose UPI/Online Payment Fraud as my cybercrime type, given its rapid rise across India and its particular relevance to college students who are active on platforms such as PhonePe, Google Pay, and Paytm.

What it is: UPI fraud involves attackers deceiving victims into authorising fraudulent money transfers through India's Unified Payments Interface. Unlike traditional bank fraud, UPI transactions are real-time and irreversible, making recovery extremely difficult.

How it happens (step-by-step): (1) The attacker identifies a victim, often via OLX or social media. (2) Trust is established by posing as a bank official or genuine buyer. (3) A pretext is created — 'Your KYC has expired' or 'I will send you money now.' (4) A UPI collect request is sent instead of a credit. (5) The victim enters their UPI PIN believing they are receiving money — this actually debits their account. (6) Funds are instantly routed to a mule account and the attacker disappears.

Who is targeted: First-time smartphone users, college students selling on second-hand platforms, elderly individuals, and small business owners. OLX sellers are especially at risk.

Consequences: Immediate and often irreversible financial loss. Victims also experience significant psychological distress, reduced trust in digital banking, and limited legal recourse since UPI payments are instant and final.

Illustrative scenario: Priya, a 20-year-old student in Bhopal, listed her laptop on OLX for Rs. 18,000. A caller claimed to be a buyer and said he would send an advance via Google Pay. Priya received a UPI notification, entered her PIN thinking she was accepting payment, and Rs. 18,000 was debited. She filed a complaint at cybercrime.gov.in and called Helpline 1930, but the funds could not be recovered.

Part B – Stay Safe Online Prevention Checklist

- ✓ **Use strong, unique passwords** (12+ characters with letters, numbers, and symbols). Use a password manager such as Bitwarden.
- ✓ **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on all accounts — email, social media, and banking apps.
- ✓ **Never share OTPs or PINs** with anyone. No bank or government body will ever ask for them.
- ✓ **UPI Safety (Priority):** Entering your UPI PIN always DEBITS money — never credits. You do not enter a PIN to receive a payment.
- ✓ **UPI Safety (Priority):** Verify the recipient UPI ID and name before every transaction. Send a Rs. 1 test transfer first for new contacts.
- ✓ **Verify every link** before clicking. Check for misspelt brand names in URLs (e.g., 'amaz0n.in').
- ✓ **Be wary of unsolicited job offers, lottery messages, and KYC-update calls.** Legitimate employers never ask for money upfront.

- ✓ **Avoid public Wi-Fi for banking.** Use mobile data or a VPN when connecting to public networks.
- ✓ **Keep apps, OS, and antivirus updated.** Enable auto-updates and run regular scans.
- ✓ **Review app permissions regularly.** Revoke camera, microphone, and location access for apps that do not need them.

Report cybercrime at: cybercrime.gov.in | National Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (24x7)

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how technically straightforward UPI fraud is — the attacker does not need to hack anything. They simply exploit the victim's unfamiliarity with how UPI collect requests work. The gap between what users think they are doing (receiving money) and what they are actually doing (authorising a debit) is the entire attack surface. One personal habit I will change as a result of this task: I will never enter my UPI PIN in response to an incoming notification without first reading the full transaction details displayed on screen, no matter how urgent the sender makes the situation feel.

Conclusion

This project provided a structured, practical introduction to digital literacy across five distinct dimensions. I began with no formal understanding of professional online profiling and ended with active accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate — platforms I will use throughout my career. I practised coding in a real evaluated environment, created a quiz that reached my peers, wrote professional emails, and produced an awareness resource on a cybercrime type that directly affects students like me. The most valuable overall learning is that digital literacy is not a one-time lesson but an ongoing practice — and that every digital action, from a social media post to a UPI transaction, carries real consequences. I will carry these lessons into every aspect of my academic and professional life.

References

Canva – Free online design tool. canva.com

GitHub – Code hosting and version control platform. github.com

LinkedIn – Professional networking platform. linkedin.com

ResearchGate – Academic research networking. researchgate.net

HackerRank – Coding practice and evaluation platform. hackerrank.com

Google Forms / Google Workspace – Form and survey creation. forms.google.com

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Ministry of Home Affairs – Cyber Crime Helpline 1930. mha.gov.in
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